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Since the dawn of time humanity has always looked for ways to live an easy and peaceful life from creating gods to shooting each other over some land and according to historians that spreading ideas in a forceful demeanor is what motivated such acts as it threatened the receiver into submission. But in modern times spreading information is easier, safe and friendly thanks to Computer scientists Vinton Cerf and Bob Kahn who are credited with inventing the internet in October 29, 1969.

The Start

ARPANET Sends Its Very First Message (1969)

Funded by the U.S. Department of Defense's Advanced Research Projects Agency (ARPA), ARPANET established the first successful host-to-host connection between UCLA and Stanford University. The intended message was "LOGIN," but the system crashed after transmitting only the first two letters, "LO"—a humble yet historic start to networked digital communication.

TCP/IP Protocol Suite Standardization (1983)

On January 1, 1983, ARPANET officially adopted TCP/IP (Transmission Control Protocol/Internet Protocol), designed by Vint Cerf and Bob Kahn. This established a standardized universal language, allowing vastly different computer hardware and local networks to seamlessly interoperate—marking the official technical birth of the modern internet.



Domain Name System (DNS) Launch (1984)

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Paul Mockapetris created the Domain Name System (DNS), fundamentally changing how users navigated the web. By translating complex, numerical IP addresses (such as 192.0.2.1) into intuitive, human-readable domain names ending in top-level extensions like .com, .edu, and .org, accessing online resources became far more practical for everyone.

Invention of the World Wide Web (1989-1991)

While working at CERN, British scientist Tim Berners-Lee invented the World Wide Web to help researchers share information across networks. He introduced HTML, HTTP, and URLs, building the initial web server, browser, and editor. The world's first public website went live in August 1991, laying the foundation for consumer internet access.

Mosaic Web Browser Brings Visual Navigation (1993)

Marc Andreessen and Eric Bina developed Mosaic at the NCSA, releasing the first widely popular graphical web browser. By allowing inline multimedia and pictures to display on the same page as text, Mosaic transformed the web from an academic text-based medium into a rich, user-friendly visual platform that spurred mainstream adoption.

Commercialization Boom and Modern Search Engines (1995-1998)

The National Science Foundation fully lifted restrictions on commercial traffic across NSFNET in 1995, prompting an explosion of commercial websites like Amazon and eBay. In 1998, Google was founded, revolutionizing web discovery through its PageRank algorithm, which brought structure and searchability to the rapidly expanding, chaotic web landscape.

CURRENTLY

Web 2.0 Shift and the Mobile Smartphone Revolution (2004-2007)

The mid-2000s marked a dynamic shift toward interactive, user-generated platforms (Facebook launched in 2004, YouTube in 2005) known as Web 2.0. Shortly after, the release of the iPhone in 2007 revolutionized how people accessed the web, shifting computing away from static desktop terminals toward an always-connected mobile lifestyle.

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